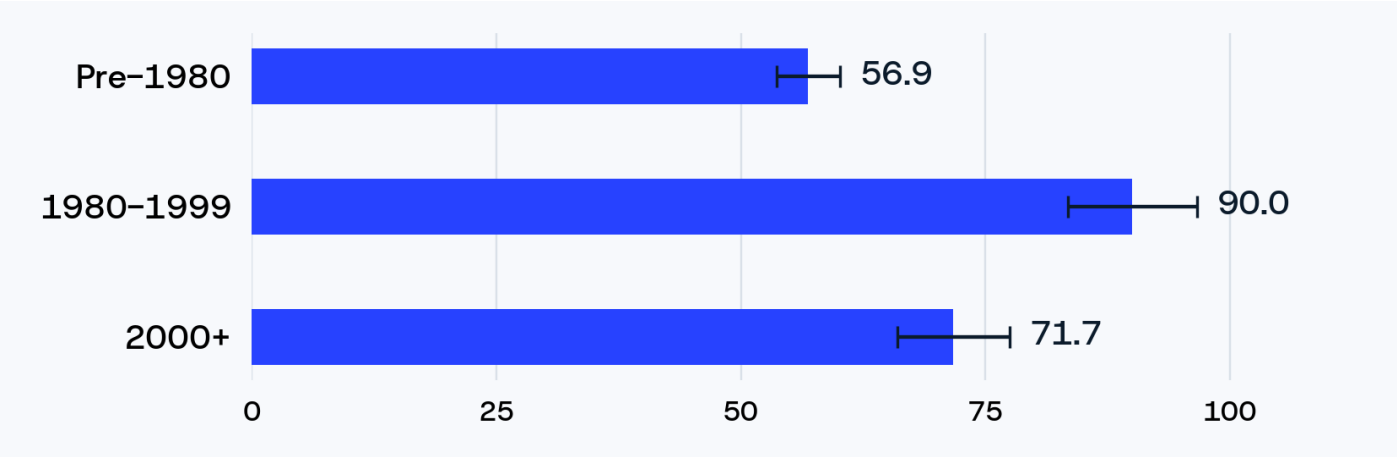
# Home-service demand changes with the service.

Three findings from an original analysis of 28,192 occupied owner homes in the 2023 American Housing Survey. Historical household projects, not an advertising-performance benchmark.

## 1. The oldest homes do not lead every category

Homes reporting professional-category central A/C work per 1,000 owner homes, by year built. Whiskers show pointwise 90% intervals.




Central A/C has a middle-vintage peak in this sample. Home age is not equipment age. The comparison does not establish a cause or validate an age-targeted ad campaign.

## 2. Count share and spending share differ

52.6% of projects / 74.8% of known spending
Professional-category plumbing fixture work. The paired difference is 22.3 percentage points (90% interval 19.4–25.1).

## 3. A typical cost still has a wide spread

$6,500 median / $4,000–$9,500 middle half
Professional-category central A/C jobs. The range is an interquartile range, not a confidence interval or a current replacement quote.

Read each figure with its denominator. Census's professional category means most work was done outside the household; paid contractor invoices are not verified. Costs combine different addition/replacement scopes.

Data preparation: October 12, 2026, version1.0. Brief prepared with OpenAI Codex. This is company-published secondary analysis; no client observations or Census/HUD endorsement.

# Use the source. Keep its limits.

## Eight prespecified services, one household survey

| Project category | Homes /1,000 | Cost median |
|---|---|---|
| Insulation | 20.1 | $2,000 |
| Interior water pipes | 26.4 | $1,600 |
| Plumbing fixtures | 60.0 | $860 |
| Electrical wiring / panels | 52.1 | $1,500 |
| Central A/C | 69.3 | $6,500 |
| Built-in heating | 59.7 | $4,500 |
| Septic tanks | 5.5 | $4,500 |
| Water heaters | 59.3 | $1,300 |

Homes/1,000: at least one professional-category project, all owner homes retained. Cost median: known nonnegative professional-category project outlays, including zero. Categories overlap; do not sum rates. Electrical includes wiring, panels, fuse boxes and built-in lighting.

## What an editor needs to know

Population and time: US occupied owner homes; projects reported for the 24 months before the 2023 interview. This is neither a calendar-year total nor a 2026 local-demand forecast.

Method: survey-weighted estimates; 160 Fay BRR replicates and pointwise 90% intervals, without multiplicity correction. Selected primary PUF workbook controls reproduce at displayed precision (183/183); that is not an independent audit of the survey.

Edition and reliability: DataLumos 217661/V2 archival copy. Input hashes are pinned; equality to original Census-distributed binaries is unverified. The small septic 2000+ cell and corresponding model contrast are withheld in the full report.

## Source, reuse and the next local question

Report, aggregate data, figures, 46 tests and source-only code: lonta.io/research/home-service-demand/
Survey archive: doi.org/10.3886/E217661V2. Cite Census/HUD, the archive edition and Lonta's analysis. Original Lonta aggregates/figures/commentary: CC BY 4.0; code: MIT. Underlying source terms remain separate.

Use the findings to frame a service hypothesis, then test it with your own inquiries, collected contribution and qualified team capacity. The companion kit includes a separate blank planning workbook.